PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

June 15, 2026
Policy Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Policy Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon Street, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendees

Committee Members: Rashelle Chase-Miller (Committee Chair); Michele DePass; Stephanie Engelsman

Other attendees: Patte Sullivan - Board Member; Emily Courtnage - Senior Legal Council; Sharon Toncray - Chief Legal Officer; Jey Buno - Chief of Student Supports; Renard Adams - Chief Accountability and Equity Officer; Will Fernandez - Director, Racial Equity and Social Justice.

Call to Order / Introductions

Committee Chair DePass called the meeting to order at 4:33 pm.

Public Comments

- Elise Huang - Student who shared she learns better from a teacher and not AI tools.
- Holly Hofkamp - Shared concerns about the two pilot AI programs.
- Kelley Albrecht - Expressed concerns about education technology and AI.
- Lisa Jackson Spottedelk - Would like to see Native Americans specifically named in the Racial Educational Equity Policy.

Revised District Student Council By-Laws

This item is postponed until August.

Policy Proposal: Protecting Student Access and Safe Schools

Will Fernandez provided background on the requirement and timeline for the proposed policy to be in place by September and shared an Immigration Enforcement tool kit that is currently being used by schools. There were questions about student data collection, sharing of information, and whether an AI policy would address these concerns.

Discussion: Screens in Classrooms

Staff provided an overview of screen time, digital literacy, educational tools, online safety, and research. There were questions about monitoring classes for adherence to digital guidelines, blocking of inappropriate content, and the use of screens in grades K-2. Committee members expressed a desire to have both screen use and AI policies and referenced a resolution passed by the Los Angeles Unified Board of Education on screen time in classrooms.

Discussion: Purchasing and Contracting Rules

Committee members noted that contract amendments that fall below the required 125% threshold are not seen by the board and there were questions about the ability to provide reports for the Board. There was a request to understand more about what other districts are doing. There was agreement to discuss further in August.

Policies in the Public Comment Period

It was noted that the 2.00.000 section policies are currently out for public comment.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

There were none.

Adjourn

Committee Chair DePass adjourned the meeting at 5:59 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell

Senior Board Manager / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools
